

5. The photograph shows an adult North Sea cod (*Gadus morhua*).



- (a) Cod are important in maintaining biodiversity in the North Sea.
Choose the letter (**A - C**) from the list which defines biodiversity for an area. [1]

- A** The total number of species
- B** The variety of species and the number of organisms within those species
- C** The variety of species and their feeding relationships

Answer

- (b) Read the following information about cod.

- Overfishing in the second half of the 20th century had a serious effect on the stocks of adult cod in the North Sea.
- The **total** stock of adult cod is estimated annually.
- The **safe** stock is the minimum mass of the adult cod population that should be left in the sea each year to ensure that the cod remains at sustainable levels.
- In 1996, scientists predicted that without action there would be no adult cod in the North Sea by 2015.
- In 2005, the European Commission put an annual limit (quota) on the mass of cod that could be taken by each vessel fishing in the area.

